

# Byu Pathways Service Missionary Guidebook

*This is a web-handbook that will be updated regularly*

Welcome to BYU Pathways Service Mission!  
Pathways is constantly changing to accommodate our growth of students, classes, and service missionaries.

Because of this please check back regularly for updated information.

If you have any questions please contact your District Leaders or Zone Leaders.



*"Our purpose is to help youth and young adults deepen their conversion to Jesus Christ and His restored gospel, qualify for the blessings of the temple, and prepare themselves, their families, and others for eternal life with their Father in Heaven."*

# Recent News

| 2026             | Winter Semester |              | Spring Semester                                                           |           | Winter Semester |             |
|------------------|-----------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------|-------------|
|                  | Term 1          | Term 2       | Term 3                                                                    | Term 4    | Term 5          | Term 6      |
| Start<br>Mondays | January 5       | March 2      | May 4                                                                     | June 29   | August 31       | October 26  |
| End<br>Saturdays | February 21     | April 18     | June 20                                                                   | August 15 | October 17      | December 12 |
|                  | 1 Week break    | 2 week break | :There is a 1 week break between terms and 2 week break between semesters |           |                 |             |

Brother Christensen's  
recent Micro Training

Master List of trainings

# Training Expectations

**3 Week Training course:** You will go through an introductory teacher training course with Brother Christensen. This will be your main source in learning to Focus on Jesus Christ, Teaching the Doctrine, and Inviting Diligent Learning.

During this training you'll be contacted about your missionary tag, Zoom Pro account and BYU pathway email.

(Be patient as these can take a week or two to provision.)

**7 Week 1st term training:** Alongside your first class you will go through our 1st term teacher training with your Training District Leader. You will meet once a week where we will help you:

- Log into Canvas

- Log into Zoom

- Learn how to use Canvas (announcements, modules, class lists, and grading)

- Learn how to use Zoom (Your zoom link, hosting a class, breakout rooms, share screen)

**2nd Term training:** During your second term you will meet bi-weekly with your new 2nd Term Training District Leader.

Here you will review:

- Zoom tech, Canvas tech, Teaching in the Savior's way

**District Placement:** In your third term you'll be placed with your regular District Leader who will help and guide you as needed throughout your classes.



**Yearly Compliance training:** You will be contacted about this during the training period around August-October. This is standard Church workforce training and will need to be done every year, however some teachers are unable to log in. If you have this issue let your District Leader know.

# Religion Courses information

## What course will I be teaching?

Each term you will be assigned to teach one of the following seven courses offered to Pathway students. Students are invited but not required to register for classes in the following order:

REL 250: Jesus Christ and His Everlasting Gospel • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)  
REL 275: Teachings & Doctrine of the Book of Mormon • Part A • Part B  
REL 225: Foundations of the Restoration • Part A • Part B  
REL 200: The Eternal Family • Part A • Part B  
REL 290: The Divine Gift of Forgiveness • Part A • Part B  
REL 333: Teachings of the Living Prophets • Part A • Part B  
REL 280: Answering My Gospel Questions • Part A • Part B

*These are links to the SandBox courses.*

*There are no students or classes in these. Feel free to use them for Substituting or exploring classes you may be interested in teaching.*

**Resources for teaching:** Always refer to your canvas course for quotes and scripture references first.

**Videos:** Any video is allowed that is from the official church website/social media pages. If it is not then check with your District Leader before showing it in class. Never show an AI generated video.

## Courses have 28 weeks

Part A

Lessons 1-14

2 lessons per week

Part B

Lessons 15-28

2 lessons per week

**What do students study?** Students are given both topics to study and pick *one* lesson to study for the week

**What do teachers study?** Teachers discuss both topics/lessons each week

*See Next Page for examples*

*Remember these are Discussion based classes. Students have already studied the subjects and your role is not to teach the material again, but to encourage them to dig deeper and help them connect the Saviors Gospel to their own lives.*

# Religion Courses information

▼ Week 02: Trusting Jesus Christ, Our Premortal Savior and Leader & Finding Purpose and Joy in the Lord's Creations

Complete All Items

Lesson 3 Teacher Materials

Lesson 4 Teacher Materials

## Due Midweek



W02 Connection

Jan 16, 2025 View



W02 Readings

Jan 15, 2025 2 pts Submit

## Due End of Week



W02 Attendance

Jan 18, 2025 3 pts Submit



W02 Reflection

Jan 18, 2025 2 pts Submit

This is what *teachers* see.

Notice there are lessons 3 & 4

You will study both lessons and discuss them in class. You will not get through everything in both lessons so prayerfully consider the needs of your class.

## W02 Readings

Due Jan 15, 2025 at 11:59pm

Points 2

Questions 1

Available until Jan 29, 2025 at 11:59pm

Time Limit None



🔊 Prepare to learn by listening to a hymn or song. 📝 Create a note in the Notes section of Gospel Library to record your thoughts and impressions. Begin with prayer.

"There has never been a time in the history of the world when knowledge of our Savior is more personally vital and relevant to every human soul" (President Russell M. Nelson, "[Pure Truth, Pure Doctrine, and Pure Revelation](#)," *Liahona*, Nov. 2021, 6). Each week, you will study questions related to Jesus Christ and discuss what you are learning with your peers.



Study

Choose **one** topic to study. Then start the quiz below when you're ready to report on your studies.

► Topic A: Our Premortal Savior

► Topic B: Finding Purpose in Creation

Select **Take the Quiz**.

This quiz was locked Jan 29, 2025 at 11:59pm.

◀ Previous

Next ▶

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This is what the *students* will see. They choose **one** topic to study each week.

# Zoom Settings and set up

## First time log in

You will be emailed that you have been provisioned a pro zoom account. Using your BYU Pathway email you can log in and see your new pro Zoom account.

If you have not gotten this email you can still try to log in to see if the email was delayed.

## Zoom Link

You will use your **personal meeting room zoom link** for each class. When you've logged in click on the *meetings* on the tab beside your profile.

Then **Personal Meeting room**.

The **blue link** is your personal meeting room zoom link.

*\*Make sure to copy this to your class, as well as your Zone Excel Teacher list.*

## Zoom Settings

You must make sure your settings are correct for your class.

- Auto record on
- Waiting room disabled
- Students may join before host

These settings ensure substitutes may enter your class in an emergency.

For step by step instructions please follow this PDF that will show you exactly how to do this.

[Zoom Settings Instructions PDF](#)

# Resources available to you

## Did you know that you have access to Office 365?

Office, Excel, Powerpoint, and more.

Just log in using your BYU Pathway email

## Additional resources for lesson planning

### Resources Microtraining

### [ldsbots.com](https://ldsbots.com)

An AI chat bot that uses only LDS references for searches.

For questions like: *What are some conference talks that discuss Jesus Christ being the creator of the earth?*

***Should only be used as a search engine for finding original references.***

\*All answers should be drawn from the original conference talks, scriptures, and references shown by the bot. It is still capable of mistakes. Never directly quote the bot.

### **Using AI:**

AI is a useful tool for refining information, asking general questions and understanding policy.

It should never be used for spiritual guidance, reflections, or in the place of human communication.

***Good for writing information communication.***

***Bad for writing a spiritual message for your class.***

## Can I use social media posts?

Yes, but only from the official church social media pages. Never use a video or picture from a secondary/fan account.

## Can I use devotionals or BYU talks?

Yes, any talk given by the apostles and prophets can be used in class.

## Can I show scenes from The Chosen?

No. While spiritual in nature and encouraging spiritually, The Chosen filming team is not in affiliation with the LDS church and cannot be used in official class curriculum.





# Attendance

## Manual attendance must be taken for accurate records

Zoom recordings, Zoom reports are inaccurate and do not reflect correct student count or time of attendance.

If a student does not turn on their camera for the duration of the class, or participate with audio they will not be anywhere on the recording.

User reports have stated that Zoom Reports also does not accurately reflect participants and the time attended.

## **What can I use for attendance?**

This can be a paper, spreadsheet, or screenshot. (For international classes do your best, but remember that the main focus is the spirit of the class not attendance accuracy.)

*According to the current syllabus, weekly Religion gatherings are an essential part of the course. Students are expected to attend, arrive on time, stay for the entire gathering, and participate. Missing gatherings or leaving early may negatively affect both their learning and their final grade.*

## Students need to be present for a majority of the class and participate fully.

Students are *encouraged but not required* to have cameras on, audio working, or participate in chat as much as possible.

Any policy for your particular class regarding attendance in your class (a point system or time frame requirement) must be communicated to students in clear instructions.





# Make up work

## Make up work for missing Gatherings

*A Sacred Trust Our goal in managing attendance is not to be punitive but to "feed" and nourish our students. This policy should be administered with empathy and a focus on the student's growth.*

**Currently the make up work can be found in the make up work framework.**

*\*Coming in January we will be changing this policy to sending the recordings for making up a gathering.*

### **Canvas Grading Limitation**

Canvas calculates grades cumulatively across all course components, including readings, reflections, and attendance. As a result, a student can still earn a passing grade (75% or higher) by completing the readings and reflections while attending only a few gatherings.

This is a limitation of how Canvas calculates grades and is not something instructors can change. Instructors also should *not* deduct points from other completed assignments to compensate for missed attendance.

*Although this limitation exists, students should continue to be encouraged to attend the weekly Zoom gatherings. Instructors are asked not to proactively explain this grading loophole to students unless they specifically ask, as doing so may unintentionally encourage students to participate only at the minimum level required.*

## [Make up work Framework PDF](#)

We are aware of recent natural disasters affecting students and instructors in your area, including earthquakes in **Venezuela** and flooding in and around **Accra, Ghana**. We are saddened by the impact and are keeping students, instructors, and their families in mind.

### **What to know**

Some students may be experiencing power outages, limited internet access, or other disruptions that affect their ability to participate in coursework.

### **What we need you to do**

- Ensure missionary teachers are aware of the situation
- Reinforce that teachers should provide flexibility and reasonable accommodations for affected students
- Ensure teachers encourage students to communicate as soon as they are able
- Watch for students who may need additional outreach or support and coordinate locally as needed

# Missionary Care Package

## Missionary Care Package

The missionary care package is sent to all new missionaries before the start of their first term.

Zoom Training course: Used in the first training term along with your Training District Leader.

New teacher checklist: Checklist for new teachers and weekly class checklist

Introduction page/ Devotional sign up page: Instructions on how to insert an introduction page and devotional sign up into your course.

Instructor Standards and Expectations:

# Reflections

## Reflections

Encourage students to have a deep meaningful reflection.

For international classes

Google translate is an appropriate way to convey reflections when english skills feel lacking.

**Using AI for reflections is not allowed.** For international classes this may need to be reiterated.

**If you suspect AI was used for a reflection:**

Go to [GPTZero.me](https://gptzero.me) copy and paste the reflection into the text box and press check.

It will tell you if it was human, or what percent was AI.

If it comes back as AI, respectfully contact your student and let them know they will need to resubmit their reflection to get full points.

*Commenting on Reflections should always be with kindness and respect.*

*Using reflections in lessons, as examples, or quotes should always be with explicit permission from the student.*

Elder Gong, June 2026 “Use Technology Wisely”

Artificial intelligence can answer questions, but it cannot answer prayers. It can organize information, but it cannot offer revelation, covenant connection, or divine truth.

In our personal lives, please use AI for logistics and drafts, but not as a substitute for trusted relationships. Set boundaries.

# International classes

If you are an english speaker these courses will be in english. Some students are new to english and may have a hard time reading or speaking without thick accents. Closed caption can be turned on by clicking *More*.

## Time zone

Make sure you are listing the class time accurate to the area of your class.

\*I always list my time of meeting like this:

Class time: **Thursdays 5pm** (UTC-6) (Salt Lake City, Utah, USA Time- 8pm)  
Google what time it is in Salt Lake City to make sure your on time for class.

## Tips

Set announcements to auto post one hour before class to remind students at the start of class time.

No video? Ask student to change their profile pictures to a picture of themselves. That way you can see their faces instead of a black screen.

## Break out rooms

Even if you do not have a very talkative class, breakout rooms can encourage students who would not usually speak to feel like they have a space among peers to speak. Assigning a leader can help them draw others out of their shell.

When struggling with communication remember to make things clear beyond just words. Big hellos and big goodbyes help students understand the beginning and end of class.

## Whats app

This can be an encouraging tool for your class communication due to data costs for students.

However it is not required and should not be used in replacement of canvas or zoom. Prayerfully consider this resource for your particular class.



*Remember that we are building the foundations of good student behavior with the mercy and grace of Christlike instruction. Be mindful, kind, and understanding that these students are doing their best and we have the opportunity to handle them with mercy.*